Lesson 1: AI in Plain Words: Your First AI Assistant

Module 1 | 60 minutes | Chatbots, safely | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Objective: Understand what an AI chatbot is (and is not), set up free accounts safely, and turn a rough note into a polite email you would actually send.

Success criteria

- I can explain in plain words what an AI chatbot does.
- I can set up and use two free AI tools.
- I can follow the privacy rules and use placeholders.
- I can turn a rough note into a polite email and check it before sending.

Key vocabulary

- **AI chatbot**: A tool you type to (like ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot) that writes a reply for you.
- **prompt**: The message or instruction you type to the AI.
- **hallucination**: When the AI makes something up and says it confidently, like a wrong date or a promise you never made.
- **placeholder**: A blank like [Client name] that you use instead of real private details.
- **free plan**: The no-cost version of a tool, with daily limits on how much you can use it.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash and the AI tools for this lesson
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone)
- Learner accounts only where allowed: see the course safety notes
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Project files: l01_ai_starter_kit.md, l01_teacher_demo_script.md

Timed lesson plan (60 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	“Finish my sentence” prediction game (see Unplugged). Link it to how chatbots work.
4 min	**Watch + poll**	Play the lesson video. Thumbs poll: “Who has used ChatGPT, Gemini or Copilot before?” and “Who has ever trusted a WhatsApp forward that was wrong?”
6 min	**Live demo**	Rough note to polite email in two tools; class spots anything the AI added that was not in the note.

10 min	**Build along (pairs)**	Set up two accounts, open the privacy settings, write the first email. Pair helpers support anyone stuck on sign-up.
10 min	**Prompt Lab**	Prompt Lab: rough note to polite email. Learners check, improve, then paste into two tools and compare.
7 min	**Team game**	Quick competition: “Safe to paste or not?” sort, played in two teams. Fastest correct team explains one tricky card.
6 min	**Breakout pairs**	Pairs swap their drafts and hunt for one invented detail or wrong fact. Then do the safe-email routine order game.
5 min	**Show-and-tell**	Three volunteers read out their before (rough note) and after (email) and say what they edited.
4 min	**Probe**	New situation: the surprise discount (individual), and start “My AI starter kit”.
3 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket, homework, and save the five starter prompts from the project kit.

Unplugged warm-up

Finish my sentence (5 min): say the start of common office phrases (“Please find the...”, “Sorry for the...”, “Thank you for your...”) and the class shouts the next word. Then say: “You just did what a chatbot does: predict the most likely next word. Did anyone know the actual fact? No. That is why AI can sound right and be wrong.”

Teaching the idea

Start with what learners fear: that AI is complicated. It is not. A chatbot is a very well-read assistant that predicts the next words of a helpful reply; it is not a search engine and it does not “know” facts the way a book does. That is why it is brilliant at drafting and rewording, and why it can confidently make things up. Today everyone sets up at least two free accounts, learns three privacy rules, and sends themselves a polite email made from a rough note. Keep every example from real Indian workplaces: a shop, a school, an office, a CA firm.

Analogy: A chatbot is like a very well-read new intern on day one: fast, polite and full of ideas, but it does not know your customers, so you check its work before it goes out.

Live demo: 1) Share your screen with ChatGPT and Claude (or Gemini) open in two tabs. 2) Read out a rough note: “order late, truck stuck because of heavy rain, new delivery Thursday, sorry, 5% off next order”. 3) Type the prompt from the video into the first tool. Point out the subject line and polite tone. 4) Ask the class: “Is anything in this email NOT in my note?” Look for invented times, dates or promises; if the AI happens to be accurate, show the 11 am example from the video. 5) Paste the same prompt into the second tool and compare in one sentence. 6) Show the privacy settings page of one tool and where the data controls are. Never type a real customer’s details on screen.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
Is a chatbot the same as Google search?	No. Search finds existing pages; a chatbot writes a new answer by predicting words, so it can be wrong.
Name two things you will never paste into an AI tool.	Any two of: passwords, Aadhaar/PAN, bank details, client data, confidential company files.
What is a placeholder?	A blank like [Client name] used instead of the real private detail.
Why try the same prompt in two tools?	To compare drafts, catch made-up details, and keep working if one tool hits its limit.
Who is responsible for an email the AI drafted?	You are, because you send it.

Differentiation

Support
Pair a confident learner with a nervous one for account setup. Learners who struggle to type can use the microphone button on the phone app to speak their rough note.

Stretch
Ask the AI to write the same email in three tones (formal, friendly, very short) and decide which suits which customer.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
AI looks things up, so its facts are correct.	It predicts words. Check every name, date, number and promise.
If the account is free, my data does not matter.	Free or paid, never paste private or client data. Use placeholders.
I need to learn coding or special commands.	You just type normal sentences, in English or Hindi.
One tool is “the best”, so I only need one.	Each tool has strengths and limits; knowing two keeps you flexible.

Assessment

Use the Prompt Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Give one example of something you will never paste into an AI tool, and say why.

Homework
Use your starter prompt on two real rough notes from your work this week (with placeholders). Note one thing the AI got wrong or added, and how you fixed it.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Prompt Lab: rough note to polite email (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Say what you want written (an email) · Say who it is for · Ask for a tone · Include the facts from the note · Set a length

Strong example:

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Turn my rough note into a short, polite email to a client. Note: our meeting is moved
from Tuesday to Wednesday at 3 pm, the venue is the same, and please bring last
quarter's numbers. Keep it under 80 words and end with a thank-you.
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2. Safe to paste into a personal AI account, or not? (perform · categorize)

Safe to paste: A rough note: "meeting moved to Wednesday 3 pm", A public news article about a GST change, A template letter that says [Client name] instead of the real name, The list of product categories in your shop
Never paste (or replace with placeholders first): Your email password, A customer's Aadhaar number for KYC, A client's balance sheet from the CA office, A photo of your PAN card, Your colleagues' salary details

3. What is it really doing? (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: Predicting a likely, helpful reply, word by word, from patterns it learned

4. The safe email routine (perform · ordering)

Order: Replace private details with [placeholders] → Write your prompt with the facts and the tone → Read the AI's draft fully → Check every name, date, number and promise against your note → Edit it into your own voice → Put the real details back and send

5. New situation: the surprise discount (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Delete the discount line, then check the rest of the email before sending

6. My AI starter kit (probe · free response)

Look for: prompt, never, check. **Example:** I set up ChatGPT and Gemini. One saved prompt: "Turn my rough note into a short, polite email to a customer. Note: [paste note]. Under 80 words." My rule: I never paste customer names, phone numbers or invoices; I use placeholders and I check every draft before sending.

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** AI chatbot = A tool you type to (like ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot) that writes a reply for you. · prompt = The message or instruction you type to the AI. · hallucination = When the AI makes something up and says it confidently, like a wrong date or a promise you never made. · placeholder = A blank like [Client name] that you use instead of real private details.
2. **Prompt Lab: rough note to polite email:** Include: Say what you want written (an email); Say who it is for; Ask for a tone; Include the facts from the note; Set a length. Example: Turn my rough note into a short, polite email to a client. Note: our meeting is moved from Tuesday to Wednesday at 3 pm, the venue is the same, and please bring last quarter's numbers. Keep it under 80 words and end with a thank-you.
3. **Safe to paste into a personal AI account, or not?:** Safe to paste: A rough note: "meeting moved to Wednesday 3 pm", A public news article about a GST change, A template letter that says [Client name] instead of the real name, The list of product categories in your shop · Never paste (or replace with placeholders first): Your email password, A customer's Aadhaar number for KYC, A client's balance sheet from the CA office, A photo of your PAN card, Your colleagues' salary details
4. **What is it really doing?:** B. Predicting a likely, helpful reply, word by word, from patterns it learned — A chatbot predicts words. That is why it writes so smoothly, and also why it can sound sure while being wrong.
5. **The safe email routine:** 1 Replace private details with [placeholders] · 2 Write your prompt with the facts and the tone · 3 Read the AI's draft fully · 4 Check every name, date, number and promise against your note · 5 Edit it into your own voice · 6 Put the real details back and send

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